

[Report 017] Celonis - Head of Industry - Retail & CPG

Score: 3.1/5
URL: <https://job-boards.greenhouse.io/celonis/jobs/6313858003>
PDF: 
Legitimacy: Proceed with Caution
Verification: confirmed (WebFetch)
Date: 2026-05-21

A) ROLE SUMMARY

Dimension	Detail
Archetype	AI Transformation + Innovation Lab Lead (hybrid)
Domain	Enterprise SaaS / Retail & CPG vertical
Function	Build / Lead / Consult
Seniority	Director/VP (industry practice lead)
Remote	Hybrid - Munich base implied
Team size	100+ professionals in the Retail & CPG practice
TL;DR	Build and lead the Retail & CPG industry practice at Celonis - vision, strategy, cross-functional team leadership, customer partnerships, and product/AI collaboration across a 100+ person org.

B) MATCH WITH CV

JD Requirement	CV Match	Strength
Build and lead cross-functional teams solving enterprise Retail & CPG challenges	Built and led 5+ university innovation labs; COVID-19 mega project (8 courses merged); cross-lectoraat coordination at Windesheim; Aeres school-wide Scrum implementation	Strong on building teams; weak on Retail & CPG domain
Entrepreneurial background with 0-to-1 building experience	Spark! Living Lab (0 → 1 from Jan 2020), Value Chain Hackers (0 → 1 self-funded), Tonomy Foundation (co-founded), Open Food Chain (early team member), COTIT (operational restructuring)	Strong - track record is built around 0-to-1
Strong public speaking and presentation abilities	Extensive: university lectures, investor pitches, workshops, conference facilitation, church organist performance background	Strong
Portfolio of successful enterprise software solutions	VCH AI traceability tooling, Beer Game demonstrator, Blockchain Minor, self-hosted AI stack (Flowise, OpenWebUI, n8n, Supabase)	Partial - lab/university scale, not enterprise commercial deployments
Translating complex concepts for diverse audiences	Bridge builder identity (Business IT & Management); Blockchain Minor for non-technical students; investor onboarding at Open Food Chain; market-stall crowd reading as trained skill	Strong
Partner directly with customers on enterprise solutions	Investor outreach, partner development, co-authored grant proposals; however no enterprise SaaS account management background	Partial
Collaborate with product and engineering leaders	DevOps lifecycle, CI/CD, Docker/Kubernetes, sprint planning; co-designed Tonomy Pangea Vault; co-wrote whitepaper	Partial - startup/lab scale
Identify and package scalable use cases	VCH CSRD/CSDDD/EUDR compliance tooling packaged for university and early enterprise use	Partial

Gaps:

1. **Retail & CPG domain expertise** - This is the biggest gap. The role is specifically the "Head of Industry - Retail & CPG." Christiaan's supply chain work (VCH, Windesheim Supply Chain Finance) touches adjacent territory, but direct Retail & CPG sector knowledge (category management, merchandising, demand planning, trade promotion) is not evidenced.
2. **Enterprise SaaS practice leadership at scale** - Managing a 100+ person industry practice is a step up from the lab/university context. The skills transfer but the scale gap is real.
3. **Go-to-market + revenue ownership** - The JD implies P&L-adjacent responsibility for a vertical. Christiaan has driven funding and partnerships but not a commercial revenue line.
4. **Celonis platform / Process Mining familiarity** - Not present; would need to be built.

Mitigation:

- Gap 1: Supply chain + traceability + CSRD compliance work gives legitimate adjacency to Retail & CPG (most CPG companies are grappling with CSRD/EUDR). This is the strongest bridge.
- Gap 2: The 0-to-1 language in the JD is a direct match to Christiaan's profile. "Build from scratch" is explicitly what he does best.
- Gap 3: The role description emphasizes vision, strategy, and execution - not just revenue quota. Frame as ecosystem builder, not sales lead.

C) LEVEL AND STRATEGY

Level detected: Director/VP - industry practice lead. This is a senior leadership hire overseeing 100+ people and owning the Retail & CPG vertical strategy.

Christiaan's natural level for this archetype: Senior Manager / emerging Director. The build-from-scratch components and cross-functional leadership match well; the scale (100+ person practice) and commercial ownership are above his demonstrated level.

"Sell senior" plan:

- Lead with 0-to-1 proof points: Spark! Living Lab built from nothing to cross-European program; Value Chain Hackers (self-funded, built with student team into live demonstrator); Aeres innovation hub (from zero to school-wide agile system in under 2 months).
- Frame supply chain background as direct Retail & CPG adjacency: VCH covers CSRD/EUDR/CSDDD - the exact compliance pressures facing every major CPG company right now.
- Position the multi-stakeholder facilitation (university, research, startup, investor audiences) as the cross-functional leadership signal.
- Highlight: "I've built the room where the learning and experimentation happens - five times. This role asks me to build it at industry scale."

"If downleveled" plan: Accept a Principal / Senior Solutions Architect role in the Value Engineering org. Negotiate 12-month path to practice leadership. Ensure any downlevel offer is above €65k base.

D) COMP AND DEMAND

Metric	Data
Head of Industry / Practice Lead at Tier-1 SaaS (EU)	€140,000-€220,000 OTE (base + variable + RSU)
Celonis compensation reputation	Competitive; RSU + unlimited PTO confirmed; Glassdoor senior roles €120k-€180k base
Christiaan's target	€65,000-€90,000 (fractional model preferred)
Comp alignment	Far exceeds target - but role is full-time; not fractional-compatible as scoped
Demand trend	Industry practice leads in enterprise AI SaaS are in demand; Retail & CPG AI transformation is a growth area

Sources: Glassdoor, LinkedIn salary data, JD compensation section.

Note: The comp overshoot is not a problem if the role delivers ownership, brand, and network access. The concern is format - this is clearly a full-time senior leadership role, which conflicts with Christiaan's 2-3 concurrent fractional model

unless Celonis is open to a consultative/fractional structure for a build phase.

E) CUSTOMIZATION PLAN

#	Section	Current status	Proposed change	Why
1	Summary	"Bridge builder between business, IT, and management"	Reframe: "Innovation builder with supply chain and AI transformation track record. Built 5 industry labs from zero; now looking to apply that model at enterprise scale in Retail & CPG."	Matches 0-to-1 language in JD
2	VCH project	Positioned as research/university	Emphasize CSRD/CSDDD/EUDR compliance tooling for CPG supply chains - directly relevant to Retail & CPG buyers	Bridges the domain gap
3	Windesheim Supply Chain Finance	Buried in work experience	Surface as enterprise-facing supply chain practice, highlight any CPG-adjacent work	Makes the domain connection explicit
4	Lab building bullet	Individual project descriptions	Group as "Built and led 5 industry-facing innovation labs" with team size context	Signals practice leadership at scale
5	Cover letter	N/A	Open with the 0-to-1 pattern + supply chain AI relevance to CPG; cite specific CSRD/EUDR pressure on Retail & CPG firms	Shows domain homework

Top 5 LinkedIn changes:

1. Headline: add "Supply Chain AI | Practice Building | Cross-functional Innovation"
2. About section: lead with 0-to-1 lab building + CPG adjacency via CSRD
3. Featured: pin valuechainhackers.xyz and demonstrator
4. Skills: add "Industry Practice Development", "Go-to-Market Strategy", "Retail & CPG"
5. Experience: update VCH to explicitly mention CPG supply chain compliance

F) INTERVIEW PLAN

#	JD Requirement	STAR+R Story	S	T	A	R	Reflection
1	0-to-1 building	Spark! Living Lab	Windesheim had no applied blockchain/AI lab	Build a lab with zero budget and institutional support	Self-funded tools, recruited students, partnered externally	Live lab, 5+ cohorts, cross-European reach	Should have secured institutional budget earlier; self-funding created dependency
2	Cross-functional leadership	COVID-19 Mega Project	8 separate courses, separate teachers, no integration	Merge into one unified innovation track in under 2 months	Designed SafeScrum-based sprint format, aligned teachers, managed student teams	Single integrated track running within 2 months	Cross-disciplinary alignment is faster than people expect when the design is clear
3	Enterprise customer partnership	Veles Farming €2M	Student project at InHolland with "no-go" assessment	Turn it into a real venture	Moved to Aeres, became advisor and seed investor, built the team	Operating startup in Slovakia, €2M funding	Trusted my own assessment over the institutional verdict; that judgment paid off

4	Translating complex concepts	Blockchain Minor	Non-technical students, zero blockchain knowledge	Teach tokenomics and smart contracts from scratch	Designed "Build Your Own Crypto" course with hands-on milestones	Course still running independently years later	Simplicity over depth wins for adoption; design for the learner, not the subject matter expert
5	Identifying scalable use cases	VCH CSRD tooling	CPG companies facing new EU compliance mandates	Package AI-powered supply chain mapping as a replicable solution	Built demonstrator at demonstrator.valuechainhackers.xyz , documented methodology	Adopted by Windesheim research agenda, referenced in external partnerships	Demonstrators that run live are worth 10 slide decks; build the thing
6	Public speaking	Albert Cuyp Market	Hundreds of daily strangers	Draw and hold a crowd, convert to customers	Thousands of repetitions from age 15; trained the rapid-rapport skill deliberately	This is the origin of all facilitation and room-reading capability	What looks like personality is actually trained skill; name it that way

Recommended case study: Value Chain Hackers (valuechainhackers.xyz) - present as "built an AI-powered CPG supply chain compliance lab from zero, with live demonstrator, published methodology, and active university research integration." The CSRD/EUDR angle is directly relevant to Retail & CPG buyers.

Red-flag questions:

- *"Do you have P&L ownership experience?"* - "I've driven funding (€2M for Veles Farming), managed lab budgets, and structured commercial partnerships. My P&L experience is at program scale, not corporate scale - that's a growth area I'm stepping into."
- *"Why no enterprise SaaS background?"* - "I've built five applied labs that functioned as internal enterprise software practices - discovery, prototype, pilot, scale. The difference is I was building the practice, not selling an existing product. That's exactly what this role asks for."
- *"You've worked in education/research - can you operate at commercial pace?"* - "Every lab I built had to generate visible value in under 6 months or lose support. That's a commercial pace. The COVID mega project was 8 courses merged in under 2 months. I operate fast."

G) POSTING LEGITIMACY

Assessment: Proceed with Caution

Signal	Finding	Weight
Posting freshness	No date visible; Greenhouse API active; Greenhouse job ID 6313858003 (older ID pattern vs 016's 7610416003 - may be older posting)	Neutral/Concerning
Apply button	Active via Greenhouse	Positive
JD specificity	Good - mentions 100+ person team, cross-functional scope, specific deliverables	Positive
Requirements realism	Somewhat vague on years/credentials; more outcome-focused, which is positive	Positive
Celonis hiring signals	No public layoffs in Value Engineering/Industry verticals identified	Positive
Reposting detection	Lower job ID number suggests this may have been open for some time	Neutral/Concerning
Role market context	Head of Industry / Practice Lead roles legitimately stay open 3-6 months	Neutral

Context Notes: The job ID for this role (6313858003) is numerically lower than report 016 (7610416003), which typically indicates an older posting on Greenhouse. This warrants checking directly whether the role is still actively being filled. The role itself is credible and makes strategic sense for Celonis's vertical expansion.

KEYWORDS EXTRACTED

Industry practice, Retail & CPG, 0-to-1, cross-functional leadership, go-to-market, enterprise software, Value Engineering, process intelligence, AI solutions, supply chain, practice lead, strategic vision, product collaboration, partner enablement, thought leadership, scalable use cases, team building, customer success, revenue, transformation

JOB DESCRIPTION (ARCHIVED)

Archived 2026-05-21 - original posting may be removed after offer closes

Head of Industry - Retail & CPG

Location: Munich, Germany

Department: Value Engineering

Celonis is the global leader in Process Intelligence and the pioneer of Process Mining technology. As one of the world's fastest-growing enterprise SaaS companies, the organization invests heavily in advanced AI capabilities to turn data insights into immediate business action.

The Team:

The Celonis Retail & CPG Industry Practice operates with over 100 professionals across global accounts. This team combines go-to-market strategy, product development, and engineering to help clients achieve value through the Celonis software platform.

The Role:

In this position, you will lead the vision, strategy, and execution of the Retail & CPG Industry Practice. You'll work across go-to-market, product, AI, and engineering teams to build scalable software solutions. You'll serve as the internal and external representative for this industry vertical and be responsible for the success of clients, employees, and partners.

Key Responsibilities:

- Establish industry practice vision and translate it into actionable strategy
- Build and lead cross-functional teams across value engineering, sales, and AI
- Partner directly with customers on solutions aligned to their business objectives
- Collaborate with product and engineering leaders on future development
- Identify and package scalable use cases across the platform
- Enable internal teams and partners in solution deployment

Required Qualifications:

- Demonstrated experience building and leading cross-functional teams solving enterprise Retail & CPG challenges
- Entrepreneurial background with 0-to-1 building experience
- Strong public speaking and presentation abilities
- Portfolio of successful enterprise software solutions
- Excellent communication skills translating complex concepts for diverse audiences

What Celonis Offers:

Employees receive equity through Restricted Stock Units, 24 weeks of paid parental leave for primary carers, unlimited PTO in applicable regions, flexible hybrid work arrangements, learning and development support, wellness benefits, volunteer opportunities, and inclusive workplace initiatives.